



Spying via Fiverr

Popular freelance site Fiverr has been found to have offers of illegal private spying services. <https://digit.in/sep19-63>



Apple shelve 'walkie talkie' feature

The feature would reportedly have let iPhone users send texts short distances without cellular coverage. <https://digit.in/sep19-64>

ASUS ROG Strix XG248Q 240 Hz Gaming Monitor

Cloudy with a chance of 240 Hz

A SUS's ROG Strix XG248Q is one of the few 240 Hz gaming monitors to sell in India. It's got a 23.8-inch viewable area and supports both, FreeSync and G-Sync. Being an ROG Strix unit, the monitor features the signature red and black design language. Typically, excelling in one aspect always has its downsides in all the remaining aspects of a monitor and we'll have to check whether the ROG Strix XG248Q suffers from the same issues.

Build

If you've seen some of the recent ROG gaming monitors, then you'll know what to expect from the ROG Strix XG248Q. You have a 24-inch panel with bezels which are about a centimeter thick on the top and the sides whereas the bottom bezel is slightly thicker than the rest.

ASUS calls these super-narrow but we wouldn't call it ideal for multi-display setups. It's a subjective judgement which varies from user-to-user. Otherwise, the monitor itself has a very clean look from the front. The bezels themselves aren't deep (z-axis) and they have a matte finish so that they don't end up reflecting much from the monitor or from external light sources.

The panel can also be pivoted by 90 degrees in a clockwise fashion and the height is adjustable by 12 centimetres. Lastly, the panel tilts 20 degrees forward and 5 degrees inward. All these adjustment features coupled with the alignment overlay within the monitor OSD helps with ensuring an even-looking multi-display setup.

On the rear of the monitor, you have the OSD keys along with one 5-way joystick and a circular RGB LED



Price
₹37,000



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array around the mounting point. The joystick is a convenient feature but the trouble with it is that if it does break then you lose access to 5 inputs in one go. We felt that the joystick on the XG248Q required very little force for actuation.

The entirety of the rear I/O is covered with a plastic cover to maintain an aesthetically pleasing look.

Speaking of the I/O, the XG248Q has 2x HDMI, 1x DP, 3.5mm stereo out, USB 3.0 passthrough and 2x USB 3.0 ports connected to the said passthrough. The ports, however, aren't gold plated and you might end up bending the cables at an awkward angle if you wish to route them via the plastic I/O cover.

Performance

The panel in the XG248Q is by Innolux (M238HHJO-K70) and is rated for 200 Hz refresh rate but the ASUS website states that the monitor has a native refresh rate of 240 Hz. The panel has a contrast ratio of 1000:1 and uses a W-LED backlight. It's also a 6-bit panel with FRC to simulate

8 bits. The minimum response time is 1ms but the average can be about 8ms. In our colour reproduction test prior to calibration, the maximum delta E observed from among all the patches was 19.09 and the average was 2.62. The average is a bit towards the

higher side and anything above 3 can be visually identified by users. We then began calibrating the monitor and for that we had to drop the Red and Blue values by 3 each to get the colour values proper. Gamma was kept at 2.2. Post calibration, the average delta E came down to 2.1 which is still

not great but it certainly is better off than earlier.

When we switched the background to a true black image, we noticed a lot of clouding.

This is a very subjective element that might be irksome to some users. It can be quite prominently observed when you're playing video games in which most of the visuals are dark such as the recently released Wolfenstein: Young Blood and the recent Resident Evil 2 remake.

Verdict

The XG248Q is an upgrade over the older XG258Q. It packs more I/O options and saves on power. The OSD features have remained unchanged between the two units but the XG248Q is more economically priced with some ecommerce stores selling the unit at ₹37,000. Getting a monitor that is not only compatible with G-Sync but also FreeSync is becoming more common by the day and the XG248Q is one of the better units we've seen thus far.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

PANEL: TN | SCREEN SIZE: 23.8-inches | RESOLUTION: 1920 x 1080 | REFRESH RATE: 240 Hz | CONNECTORS: 2x HDMI 2.0, 1x DP 1.2, AUDIO PASSTHROUGH: Yes | CONTRAST RATIO: 1000:1 | RESPONSE TIME: 1ms (GtG) | POWER: <40 W | WEIGHT: 6.0 kg.

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